SPACE FOR SECURITY & DEFENCE:
SPACE FOR PEACE, PROTECTING EUROPE AND ITS VALUES

Over the past few weeks, space for security & defence has moved to the top of the European space agenda. On 17 September, the Mission Letter for the new position of EU Commissioner for "Defence and Space" was published. The same day, Novaspace hosted the first "Space Defense and Security Summit" (SDSS) in Paris. The **18th ESPI Autumn Conference** on 1/2 October in Vienna had a premier with its focus on "Scaling European Space Capabilities for Security and Defence", preceded by the first ESPI "Roundtable of European Space Commands and Ministries of Defence" on 30 September. Moreover, on 25 September in Zurich, at ESPI's workshop "Perspectives on a European Space Strategy", ESPI members, advisors and external experts identified security & defence as the most significant element a European space strategy should consider to secure peace, next to the economic dimension of space for prosperity (and prior to the climate change dimension).



1st Roundtable of European Space Commands & Ministries of Defence

The interaction between participants of the **SDSS Summit** and of the collocated World Satellite Business Week (WSBW) Conference was remarkable, with the space business world seeking new opportunities with security & defence actors. The Space Agencies panel at SDSS, moderated by ESPI, also made clear that European space agencies already and increasingly have a role in space and security, and that security is much more than its military dimension, with most innovation being dual-use.

The ESPI Roundtable gathered representatives from 8 different European countries, including Heads of Space Commands, and confirmed that such platform to foster exchange between military space actors in Europe to help increasing cooperation and information sharing is well received.

The ESPI Autumn Conference, with a record attendance of 250 participants, brought together different stakeholders, from military actors and industry to agencies/institutions and think tanks, national as well as European actors. The need to better leverage the existing space eco-system was at the core of the debate, i.e. to meet security challenges and respond to military needs, to develop a more integrated framework for civil, commercial & military cooperation at national and European levels. Key take-aways included the recognition that currently the rising threats are outpacing Europe's response framework, that the development of more integrated dual-use space architectures including the required R&D are critical, that the lack of political will and funding is directly hampering Europe's ability to efficiently act and react in a timely (or immediate) manner, the need for dedicated entities responsible for military space operations, the need to integrate security and military requirements into new space (and NewSpace) programmes and other initiatives ensuring agility and speed of innovation. Furthermore, the need for improved bilateral, EU, ESA and NATO cooperation was highlighted, also overcoming the often artificial barriers between civil and defence programmes. The need for a collective security framework, including the UK as a key partner and ESA with its expertise in R&D was stressed. It was concluded that Europe as a trusted global actor could also develop as a partner of choice for middle powers and increase its international posture in space.



Similarly, the strategy discussions in Zurich underlined that security comprises areas such as critical infrastructure protection, food security, economic resilience. Discussions made clear that defence does not equate to aggression but is about providing the means to deter aggression and avoid escalation of conflict, including the development of non-aggressive technologies of dual-use nature. It also made clear that security & defence cannot be disassociated from the economic dimension of space, including the effect on industrial capability.

It is high time for Europe to collectively develop the full benefits of space to security & defence solutions, leveraging the experience of all its stakeholders, to protect Europe and its values, to secure peace.

Yours sincerely,

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Director of ESPI

